Returns, Product Problems, Replacements and Refunds Policy

Document ID: MP-RET | Merchant: MaplePaw Pet Supply Canada | Version: 1.0

Effective date: 2026-10-08 | Region: Fictional Canadian storefront | Currency: CAD

Document status: Original synthetic merchant policy for software testing.

This is an original policy for a fictional retailer of physical pet supplies. Its return period, approval limits, service targets and examples are synthetic test settings. It is not a copy of a real merchant's policy or a statement about the outcome of a PayPal dispute.

Contents

MP-RET-01. Scope and remedy categories

MP-RET-02. Standard satisfaction return window

MP-RET-03. Product condition and ordinary eligibility

MP-RET-04. Requesting a return and providing information

MP-RET-05. Wrong, missing, damaged or materially different items

MP-RET-06. Return labels and customer dispatch

MP-RET-07. Unsafe, recalled or contaminated goods

MP-RET-08. Returns to sender and undeliverable orders

MP-RET-09. Refund amount and allocation

MP-RET-10. Refund destination and mixed payment

MP-RET-11. Processing and posting targets

MP-RET-12. Refund statuses and confirmation

MP-RET-13. Return loss and inspection disagreements

MP-RET-14. Replacements and substitutions

MP-RET-15. Approval controls and open disputes

MP-RET-16. Examples of correct application

MP-RET-01. Scope and remedy categories

This policy covers satisfaction returns, products materially different from their description, wrong items, missing contents, transit damage, defects, safety concerns, returns to sender and the administration of merchant refunds. Delivery loss is first assessed under MP-DEL. Payment authorization and billing errors are first assessed under MP-PAY.

A return, a replacement, a refund and a store credit are distinct remedies. A return means the customer sends goods back using approved instructions. A replacement means a new item is supplied without charging again for the same approved remedy. A refund means captured funds are returned through a payment transaction. Store credit means a balance is credited to the merchant account.

Staff record what the customer requested, what MaplePaw offered, what was accepted and what was executed. A returned parcel does not prove a refund. A replacement shipment does not prove the customer accepted that remedy. A courtesy credit does not automatically discharge an obligation to return captured payment.

MP-RET-02. Standard satisfaction return window

Eligible catalogue goods may be requested for a satisfaction return within 180 calendar days after delivery. The delivery date is day zero and the next calendar date is day one. For a split order, each line uses the delivery date of its own package. A request recorded on day 180 is within the window; a request on day 181 requires discretionary review.

If receipt occurred later than the carrier's displayed delivery date and the difference is supported by an investigation, support uses the verified receipt date. If the relevant delivery date cannot be established, staff request clarification and escalate instead of rejecting the request using an invented date.

The first documented customer report determines timeliness. A support backlog, delayed prepaid label or investigation ending after day 180 does not invalidate a report submitted within the window. Beyond-window safety complaints and established merchant fulfilment or payment errors still receive review under the specific policy; the satisfaction window is not a universal bar.

MP-RET-03. Product condition and ordinary eligibility

Unopened food, treats and supplies, clean accessories and reasonably inspected products may be returned for satisfaction reasons. Opened food or treats may also receive a satisfaction remedy where the customer reasonably tried the product and it was not suitable. MaplePaw may issue a refund without physical return where shipping the opened consumable is inappropriate.

Reasonable trial does not include intentionally destroying an accessory, modifying a product for an unrelated purpose or consuming the entire purchase while requesting reimbursement for unused goods. Staff assess the actual condition and explanation rather than infer misuse from the fact that packaging was opened.

A defect, damaged seal, expired item or materially incorrect product is reviewed as a product problem, not merely an ordinary satisfaction return. Such cases must not be denied solely

because the customer opened the package to discover the issue. MP-RET-05 and MP-RET-07 provide the relevant remedies and safety precautions.

MP-RET-04. Requesting a return and providing information

A return request should identify the order, item SKU or description, quantity affected, reason and desired remedy. Staff first locate the original order and purchase-time listing. If the customer cannot supply an order number, support may search using verified account information without requesting complete payment credentials.

Photographs, measurements, lot numbers or packaging details may be requested where relevant to a mismatch, defect or safety complaint. The request must explain the purpose. If the customer cannot provide an image, support considers other evidence such as shipment contents, a manufacturer notice or a detailed description.

MaplePaw creates a return authorization identifying approved items, quantities, reason, label instructions and remedy conditions. An authorization for one item is not authorization to return unrelated purchases. Customers should not ship goods to a warehouse address obtained from an unrelated document; the approved label supplies the proper destination.

MP-RET-05. Wrong, missing, damaged or materially different items

If MaplePaw shipped a different SKU, selected variant, pack quantity or product from the one confirmed, the merchant offers correction through replacement or refund of the affected allocation. If a bundle lacks a promised component, support checks the listing and packing record before choosing a replacement component, replacement bundle or partial refund.

A material description problem is assessed against the purchase-time listing. Examples include a bowl advertised as two litres that is substantially smaller, a harness shipped in the wrong size, a pack advertised as twelve units containing six, or food containing an undisclosed materially different formula. A preference complaint may still qualify for satisfaction return even if no mismatch is found.

Where the merchant error is confirmed, the standard return label and approved replacement delivery are free. Any affected item tax is returned with an item refund. A customer need not accept a replacement where the missing or incorrect item has made the original purpose impractical; support may offer the refund alternative.

MP-RET-06. Return labels and customer dispatch

MaplePaw supplies a prepaid standard return label for approved returns. The customer should dispatch the parcel within 21 calendar days after label issue. If the label does not arrive, expires before a reasonable dispatch opportunity, or has incorrect details, support reissues it and resets this dispatch target.

The 21-day dispatch target is a return-operation target. Missing it does not automatically undo an already timely report. Support asks whether more time or another collection arrangement is needed. Long-unexplained inactivity may lead to closing the pending return request, but the reason and reopening path must be recorded.

Customers should package goods to avoid avoidable damage and include the authorization reference. They should not include live animals, hazardous unrelated materials or other

orders. A return acceptance scan, tracking record and warehouse receipt are kept separately. An unscanned label is not proof that the goods were sent back.

MP-RET-07. Unsafe, recalled or contaminated goods

A customer reporting contamination, a broken safety-critical item, a damaged food seal, a recall or an adverse incident is instructed to stop using the affected goods. Support asks for the product, lot or batch, approximate incident time and relevant supporting details if safe to collect. It must not require repeated use to reproduce the problem.

Such cases require human review regardless of transaction amount. The reviewer decides whether the item should be quarantined, retained, safely disposed of or returned using special instructions. The ordinary prepaid return process must not be used for a leaking or otherwise unsafe item without an assessment.

A manufacturer investigation does not prevent MaplePaw from considering an appropriate immediate product remedy. This policy does not provide veterinary advice or promise compensation for every related expense. Requests involving injury, professional treatment or broader consequential costs are escalated rather than decided by an automated product-refund rule.

MP-RET-08. Returns to sender and undeliverable orders

When a carrier returns an order, MaplePaw identifies whether the cause was merchant address error, customer address error, a failed delivery attempt, voluntary refusal, a cancelled shipment or an unknown reason. A return-to-sender scan alone does not answer why the parcel returned or which delivery fee should be retained.

For merchant error or confirmed delivery failure, the customer may choose refund or reshipment without another standard delivery charge. If all goods are refunded because of that merchant failure, the original delivery fee is also refunded. For a voluntary refusal of correctly supplied goods, the ordinary return rules apply.

Where the customer supplied the wrong address and reshipment is requested, an additional disclosed delivery fee may be proposed before dispatch. If the customer declines reshipment, staff refund the returned goods and associated item tax; any original delivery fee already incurred may be retained with a written explanation. Uncertain responsibility requires human review.

MP-RET-09. Refund amount and allocation

An item refund is based on the net price actually paid for the affected quantity, after line-level discount allocation, plus the tax allocated to that quantity. It is not based on the current catalogue price or the undiscounted advertised price. A bundle discount is allocated consistently using the original order ledger.

For a full ordinary return of all delivered goods, MaplePaw refunds the original standard delivery fee. For a voluntary partial satisfaction return, the original delivery fee is ordinarily retained, and the customer is not retroactively billed because the kept items fall below the free-delivery threshold. A partial fulfilment-failure claim uses the separate delivery-fee rule in MP-DEL-11.

The total refund for an allocation must not exceed the captured amount associated with that allocation, less prior completed refunds, except where a separately approved goodwill payment is explicitly recorded as such. Compensation is not disguised as a product refund. Staff reconcile gift or store-credit funding under MP-RET-10.

MP-RET-10. Refund destination and mixed payment

Refunds normally return to the original payment route. An original PayPal capture is refunded through the linked provider transaction rather than through a new transfer to an email address. A card refund returns through the original processor route. A store-credit-funded allocation is restored to its original store-credit balance.

For mixed payment, the order ledger determines the amount originally supplied by each funding route. Refunds reverse those allocations rather than choosing a convenient route. MaplePaw may not convert the customer's cash-funded refund into expiring promotional credit without the customer's informed choice.

If the original instrument is closed, unavailable or rejected by the provider, support checks the provider's actual refund status and escalates. Staff do not promise that an unrelated bank account can receive the refund. A request to redirect a refund requires verification and separate authorization; changing destination during a fraud review is particularly sensitive.

MP-RET-11. Processing and posting targets

After approved returned goods are received, MaplePaw targets inspection and submission of the refund within three business days. For an approved refund that does not require return, the same three-business-day submission target begins at approval. Warehouse delay or a failed inspection is communicated with a reason and follow-up date.

Once the provider accepts the refund, the fictional expected funding-account posting period is five to ten business days, depending on the route. This is a test assumption, not a real processor guarantee. Support identifies the provider-accepted date and never starts the posting clock from the day the customer first requested a return.

If the provider rejects the refund, the status is failed and no posting period should be quoted as though the refund succeeded. If the posting period expires, support obtains the available provider reference and investigates under MP-PAY-05. A customer screenshot is useful context but does not replace the refund ledger.

MP-RET-12. Refund statuses and confirmation

The refund workflow distinguishes requested, approved, submitted, provider accepted, provider reported completed, failed and reversed. A provider may not supply every status, so staff retain the actual reported value and explain its meaning. The system must not manufacture a completed state just to simplify the interface.

A confirmation identifies the original order, affected allocation, refund amount, currency, submission date, provider refund ID where available and expected next step. A merchant-generated case number is not a provider refund ID. A refund promise made in a chat does not establish that a transaction was submitted.

For multiple partial refunds, the confirmation lists the separate references and total returned so far. A later refund should not overwrite an earlier one. If the provider reports completion while the customer sees no credit, the investigation remains open until the posting issue is addressed or responsibly escalated.

MP-RET-13. Return loss and inspection disagreements

If a customer uses the supplied prepaid label and the carrier accepts the return but it later goes missing, MaplePaw opens a carrier enquiry. Staff consider the authorization, package details and acceptance record. The customer is not automatically denied because the warehouse has no receipt.

If the warehouse reports the wrong item, missing contents or unexpected damage, the merchant preserves inspection records and asks the customer for clarification. A generic warehouse note without order linkage is insufficient to establish that the customer returned unrelated goods.

A contested inspection requires human review. The reviewer distinguishes uncertainty, accidental mix-up and supported misconduct rather than converting all discrepancies into fraud. The original return eligibility and the separate dispute deadline remain visible while the investigation proceeds.

MP-RET-14. Replacements and substitutions

An approved replacement should match the original SKU and variant, unless the customer affirmatively chooses an alternative. MaplePaw records the replacement quantity, linked case, dispatch record and any returned original goods. The replacement is not charged again as a new paid purchase.

If stock is unavailable, support offers a refund or a consented alternative with disclosed differences. A more expensive substitute cannot create an additional charge without fresh consent. A cheaper substitute requires reconciliation of any agreed difference.

A defective or missing replacement receives its own fulfilment review, linked to the original case. Staff do not close the case just because a replacement label exists. The remedy is evaluated against the customer's agreed resolution and the actual replacement progress.

MP-RET-15. Approval controls and open disputes

A gross proposed cash remedy of CAD 250.00 or more requires human approval. Gross proposed remedy means the total new monetary remedy across allocations in the current case before subtracting recoveries; staff must not split it into smaller actions to avoid the threshold. Safety cases, disputed authorization, conflicting evidence and contested return inspections require review regardless of amount.

These approval rules are fictional merchant controls. They do not determine external rights or provider eligibility. The decision record identifies the rule, reviewer and amount. An AI recommendation may calculate a candidate remedy but may not turn missing evidence into an approval.

Where an external dispute is open, MP-PAY-10 must be checked before executing a merchant refund. The status of earlier refunds, credits and provider adjustments is reconciled. The

customer receives a clear explanation of the selected route without an unsupported promise of immediate external case closure.

MP-RET-16. Examples of correct application

Example A: A delivered accessory is reported unsuitable on day 180 and the support team replies on day 184. The request remains timely under MP-RET-02. A later review date is not a reason to deny it.

Example B: A customer paid CAD 50.00 merchandise, CAD 2.50 fixture tax and CAD 6.50 delivery, then returns every delivered item. A full ordinary return refunds CAD 59.00 under MP-RET-09. This arithmetic is a fixture and does not state an applicable tax rate.

Example C: A customer requests a refund on Monday; the merchant approves on Wednesday and the provider accepts on Friday. The posting estimate runs from Friday under MP-RET-11. It must not be reported as overdue merely because Monday was the first contact.

Example D: An opened bag of food has a compromised seal and a disputed adverse incident. Support uses the safety-review path in MP-RET-07 and does not deny the issue under a generic unopened-only rule. This corpus has no such blanket unopened-only condition.